

Final SLICC Report

meelle crafts

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Background: SLICC Proposal

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS AND DECLARATIONS

Thank you to Cheryl Chong, Yujin Bae and Soomin Lee for giving me advice based on their previous experience running craft booths! Thank you to Nina for being my booth partner. Thank you to Victoria Feng for taking this course with me and supporting me along the way, and thank you to those who visited my booth (especially BET300 community)! Lastly, thank you to Wayne Chang for everything!

SLICC Proposal

Description

I intended to apply for a Crafts 4 Charity booth to sell crochet/paper card products, and create enough crochet and paper card products by the booth date to sell. I plan to also find a partner to share my booth with, As a stretch goal, I hope to set up an online channel for people to order on social media.

Weekly, I planned to dedicate at least 5 hours to crocheting to create a collection of products. Every 2 weeks, I planned to reach out to crocheters I know who can provide tips/guidance, and also check in if they may be interested in sharing a booth as well.

These activities relate to the Key Activities and Key Partners sections of my BMC.

As a result, I had crocheted 3 products (2 larger products and 1 small), and partnered with someone with a large supply of crochet flowers they could sell. We sold these products at the Crafts 4 Charity fair on Nov 24/25, 2025. In the future, I hope to set up an Etsy shop and sell some crochet patterns as well.

Learning Experiences and Goals

The first goal I had was to get a good understanding of how to price my items competitively.

My partner's flowers sold at \$10 per flower, and \$45 for a bouquet. My items included a sheep bag for \$30, a large strawberry plush for \$45, and a sheep airpod case for \$15. Looking around at other booths, I assessed that our products were priced fairly and competitively. However, after completing our booth, I noticed that my partner was able to sell multiple flowers, while I was only able to sell 2 (out of 3) of my products. Even though my products were priced fairly for the size of the product, I learned that for a craft booth, customers tend to buy items that are smaller and cheaper, rather than spend a lot of money on one larger item.

Learning Experiences and Goals

My second goal was to properly manage my time and balance my responsibilities to be able to make enough products to host a booth this school term.

Although I wish I had been able to make more products, I feel I learned a lot about work/life balance. It's important to give yourself the opportunity to do things outside of your normal work. For me, this benefits my mental health and allows me to do better in my school work/other responsibilities like my craft fair. For example, I was able to meet my booth partner because I decided to take some time away from schoolwork to visit a crochet club at UW. It was great to meet someone new who shares a common interest with me, share the burden of executing a craft booth, and keep me accountable.

Areas of Focus from YVI BMC

Key Activities

The main blocker for me accomplishing the goals I set were my own physical capacity to crochet enough products and find a booth partner by the booth deadline. Thus this was one of the main focuses of my work this term.

Key Partnerships

I wanted to be sure I could do a booth this term, so it was important to me that I successfully apply for the Crafts 4 Charity booth and have a partner booth with me. This means I needed some products crocheted by the application deadline in order to prove to Crafts 4 Charity that I have something to sell. Thus, this was something I kept in my mind throughout this term.

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SLICC
Learning Outcomes

LO-1: Research & Analysis (understanding & context)

I needed to research what type of products to make, what prices I should sell the products for, accessible crafts markets in the area, and what my target market could be interested in.

To gather this research, I took ideas from Pinterest instead to help me find items that I was interested in making. Next, I needed to find how much crochet products were selling for. For this, I went to Etsy and looked up items similar to what I wanted to create.

I feel my price research was accurate and my products were priced fairly. I feel that I did not do enough research into what products my target market could be interested in.

For my next craft market, I would make smaller products that I could price at \$10. I learned that students shopping at a pop-up craft booth event prefer items that they can buy impulsively without spending too much money.

LO-2: Application (of skills already learned)

At the start, I thought I was going to just apply my crochet experience and independent working skills.

I did end up applying the above skills. It was helpful that I had a lot of crochet experience and yarn from previous projects that helped me get started.

One skill I wasn't expecting apply was networking and creative marketing. I thought I would partner with someone I knew for my crochet booth, but I ended up meeting someone new at a crochet club and having them join my booth. Then, at my booth I set up a "Dance for \$5 Off" sign that I came up with based on seeing creative ideas online. I wasn't expecting too much, but it ended up attracting a lot of attention and delight towards our booth.

LO-3: Skills Development (new specific skills)

I started by thinking I was going to develop my communication skills as a boothter, and self management.

I did end up working on the above skills. My YVI challenged my self management skills a lot. I was only able to make 3 products by the booth day (although they were large), and even then I was rushing to get them done. I learned that it's important for me to schedule in proper breaks and spend time with friends/family to ensure I have enough energy to finish my work.

LO-3: Skills Development (new specific skills)

It was challenging for me to lead a booth as someone who's more soft-spoken. I improved my communication skills by learning some simple ways to talk to new customers and pull attention to our booth from my partner who was much more outspoken.

I also improved my innovation skills during the ideation process of my products, and ways to attract attention to our booth.

LO-4: Mindset

I selected the following mindset:

...**positive outlook and perseverance**: You draw on the quality, depth and breadth of your experiences to maintain a positive mindset and engage with the communities and world around you. You manage risk by learning from mistakes, and actively seek new insights to help you better contribute positively, ethically and respectfully.

This is relevant to my YVI because I drew on my crochet experience and passion for the arts community a lot as I worked on my YVI.

Having a positive outlook was important to my YVI. I felt ready to handle failures and mistakes that came up during my experience working on my YVI because overall I wanted to interact positively and contribute to the craft community at uWaterloo. I have always been an art hobbyist and wanted to take on a booth because I wanted to meet more people interested in crafts as well and get inspired.

LO-4: Mindset

Perseverance was also important to my YVI. Even though I felt my products didn't attract as much attention as my booth partner's products, I stayed open-minded and carefully reflected on what exactly didn't work. Now, I feel motivated to keep going and try new ways to properly appeal to target audiences, such as creating crochet patterns online and selling smaller items at physical crochet booths.

LO-5: Evaluation (of learning through YVI)

Since I've had many artistic hobbies since I was a kid, it felt like a big accomplishment for me experience to do a craft booth. I've visited many craft fairs and seen many of my favourite artists advertise their craft booths online, and now I have gained an even bigger respect for them now that I have more experience. There is a lot of business thinking, time management skills, and craft experience that goes into a simple, cute craft booth.

I'm glad that I achieved my goal of starting a crochet booth by the end of this term. Now, I'm equipped with more knowledge of what products would appeal to students better and I'd love to do another booth and improve my sales. However, crocheting takes a long time. That's why I want to making crochet patterns next and selling them on Etsy. This way, I made one online product and can sell it to multiple customers.

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Appendices

Appendix A: Business Model Canvas

Key Partnerships  A booth partner to help split the booth fee and supply more products. Crafts 4 Charity (and other clubs hosting craft fairs) provide affordable craft booths for boothers. BET300 class - provides great supportive network	Key Activities  Crocheting and crafting products, curating a theme for products, applying for a booth, finding a booth partner Key Resources  Social media platforms, my previous crochet and paper craft skills, crafts 4 charity	Value Propositions  For Waterloo students looking for unique and useful gifts to give their friends, meelle crafts is a local crochet shop that provides handmade functional crochet items bundled with cards	Customer Relationships  Provide instagram to customers to follow to keep up with me, or if they have any product request/issues Channels  Products will be sold through the Crafts 4 Charity craft booth fair, and other craft fairs happening at UW. I will also take online orders through my Instagram. Marketing will be done through Crafts 4 Charity's social media, my personal social media, and through general word of mouth.	Customer Segments  Students at uWaterloo and online customers in Ontario Young adults looking for unique handmade gifts to give their friends Targeting buyers prefer larger crochet items/items with function (eg. bags) over small crochet items
Cost Structure  Booth fee, time spent creating crochet products, materials cost (yarn and crochet tools)		Revenue Streams  Product sales		

Appendix B: Progress photos



Final photo for Crafts 4 Charity!

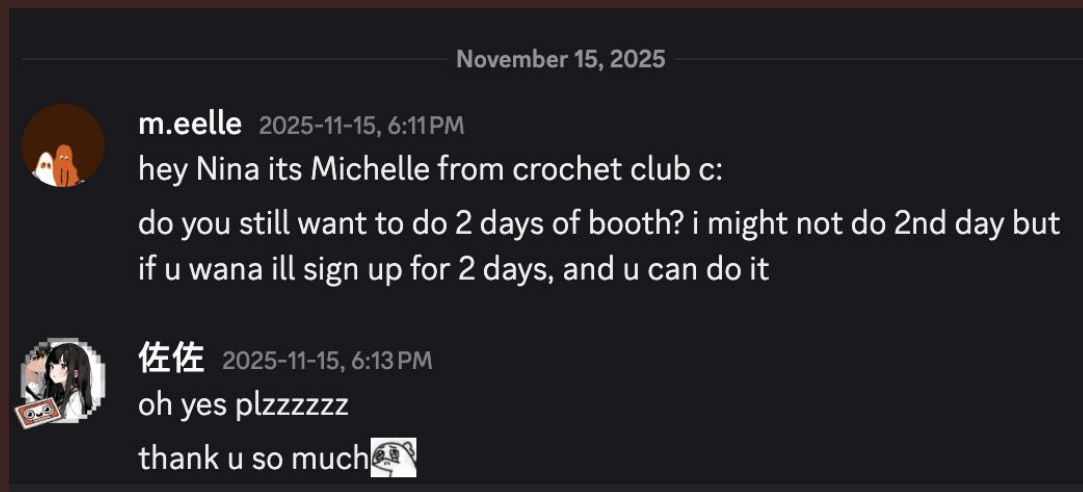


Appendix B: Progress photos

Took this picture when I first found the poster for crochet club!



*First messages to Nina, following up about
crochet booth partnering!*



Appendix B: Progress photos



Booth day 1, Nov 24!!!!